

Chapter 25-7

Liang Shi finished organizing all the materials by noon.

The housekeeper asked if she wanted lunch prepared. She was thinking about the menu in her head when she received a call from Liang Xinhe before she could figure it out.

She answered politely, "Second Brother."

"Where are you?" Liang Xinhe asked.

Liang Shi thought he was checking up on her, so she answered obediently: "At home."

"Chuanlan Villa?"

"Yes."

"What are you still doing there?" Liang Xinhe's tone was already somewhat impatient, "Liang Shi, I really thought you were going to turn over a new leaf, but you're still like this? It's one thing for you to fool around outside, but now you don't even want this family? Are you planning to sever ties with the Liang family?"

Liang Shi: "...?"

"Alright, what kind of way is that to talk to Shi?" A gentle female voice came through, "You're clearly worried about Shi and want to see her, but you use these words to hurt people. With this attitude of yours, you'll start arguing before saying a few words each time."

Liang Shi guessed this should be her second sister-in-law.

In the original book, Second Sister-in-law didn't have much screen time.

But she was a particularly positive character.

When the original owner was at her lowest point, she even gave the original owner some money, but that money was quickly lost by the original owner to gambling.

This led to her later targeting her daughter.

Liang Shi didn't know much more than that.

After all, she hadn't thoroughly read and memorized the entire text before transmigrating.

"Shi." Second Sister-in-law took over the phone, "You're supposed to return to the old residence today, right? Remember to bring your sister-in-law¹."

"Second Sister-in-law." Liang Shi's attitude was very good, "Zhuzi is sick and can't go back."

"Is it serious?" Second Sister-in-law asked with concern, "Then you stay home and take care of her. It's fine, I'll talk to Mom about it."

"How can you spoil her like this?" Liang Xinhe took back the phone, "Liang Shi, whatever you have going on today, you have to come back. What did you tell me last week? That even if knives were raining from the sky, you would still return to the old residence. Have you forgotten your own words?"

Liang Shi: "..."

That was what the original owner said.

Never mind.

She was the one now anyway.

"It's Big Brother's birthday today. You won't even come home for a meal? You might as well stop being surnamed Liang." Liang Xinhe said impatiently and hung up.

Liang Xinhe's temper was indeed somewhat quick.

But his heart was good.

Liang Shi didn't complain either. She told the housekeeper that today's lunch only needed to be made for Xu Qingya alone, while she had to return to the old residence.

Since it was Liang Xinzhou's birthday, Liang Shi had to go no matter what.

After all, she was still considered part of the Liang family for now.

It was just that the original owner's relationship with the family members was generally poor. With her troublemaking nature, she had probably caused trouble wherever she could.

In any case, it was a pile of messes.

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Liang Shi didn't know the way to the old residence, so the driver took her back.

The old residence wasn't far from the villa, but it was obviously more luxurious and had more heritage. This area was full of villa estates.

It had quite the flavor of ancient times when people occupied mountains as kings.

The Liang family's building was Gothic style, which was quite distinctive among all these villas.

As soon as her car entered the courtyard, someone came out to greet her.

When she got out of the car, the servant bowed and extended her arm, "Third Miss."

Liang Shi placed her hand on the servant's arm and got out of the car.

The entrance had elaborate architectural details, giving one the feeling of accidentally entering a museum. It was clear that the Liang family had spent quite a bit of money building this residence.

Two rows of female servants stood at the entrance. As she walked past, they bowed in unison and respectfully called out: "Third Miss."

Quite impressive.

Because she was returning to the old residence, Liang Shi had specifically gone to buy appropriate clothing.

She couldn't really accept the clothes in the original owner's closet.

Today she wore a light apricot long dress with a white suit jacket, her long hair down, and silver earrings.

Slightly bright makeup, but not overly luxurious, paired with the minimalist style white suit - low-key yet not showing disrespect.

After she entered, Second Sister-in-law was the first to notice her. Second Sister-in-law smiled and stood up, "Shi is back."

At the gilded long table, everyone had already taken their seats. Although there was still a place at the table, the extra tableware had been removed, and everyone had already assumed she wouldn't come back.

Father Liang was over sixty, in good health, sitting in the main seat. Seeing her, he only hummed lightly, "You still know to come back."

Liang Shi said awkwardly, "Sorry, I got busy and forgot."

Her tone showed clear distance.

She actually wanted to establish good relationships with these people, but unfortunately, she had never had family for so many years and really didn't know how to get along with family members. She could only try to be as polite as possible.

Moreover, everyone was used to the original owner's unrestrained style.

But the original owner was relatively well-behaved at home.

So Liang Shi didn't reveal any flaws.

She just stood there, somewhat awkwardly.

No one told her to sit, and except for Second Sister-in-law, no one else greeted her either. The girl sitting at the edge with pure features pursed her lips and said, "Third Sister."

"Mm." Liang Shi smiled at her, "Wanwan, have you started school?"

Liang Wanwan was the youngest sister in the family, just starting her junior year of college. Her personality was much more likeable than the original owner's.

"Not yet." Liang Wanwan said: "The day after tomorrow."

Liang Shi nodded.

Awkward conversation was indeed difficult.

Especially in such an almost completely unfamiliar situation, it was purely a technical skill.

"What are you all standing around for? Get Third Miss her tableware." Liang Xinhe finally spoke up, "Each one of you, don't you have any sense?"

The servants immediately went to get them, and another servant pulled out a chair for Liang Shi.

Liang Shi sat down. Across from her was a little girl.

Probably three or four years old, wearing a pink hair clip, looking at her with timid eyes.

She should be Liang Xinhe's daughter.

Second Sister-in-law taught her, "Lingdang, greet your aunt."

The child bit her lip and after a while called out: "Aunt."

Liang Shi smiled, "Mm, long time no see, you've gotten even prettier."

The little girl's expression relaxed slightly.

Liang Shi had been observing her expression. She had originally thought the original owner shouldn't have done anything to such a small girl, but now she felt that she probably hadn't spared even such a small child, making the kid still watch her face carefully.

She tried to make her smile as gentle as possible.

Today was Liang Xinzhou's birthday. She recognized this eldest brother at first glance when she came in.

A typical business elite, wearing a black suit and glasses, with a cold beauty sitting beside him - the eldest sister-in-law.

Qiu Zimin sat together with Father Liang, both in the main seats.

Probably because they had argued on the phone before, when she saw her today, she didn't have a good expression either, her eyes gloomy.

Liang Shi didn't deliberately try to please her either.

Anyway, she would eventually break ties with the Liang family. She just needed to wait until the Liang family found their biological daughter, and her connection with this place would be over.

Now it was just going through the motions. It was clear that everyone in this family didn't really welcome her back.

Although Liang Xinzhou and Liang Xinhe were both married, they had always lived in the old residence without establishing separate households.

Only she had moved to Chuanlan Villa immediately after marriage.

Was it because there wasn't enough room?

Certainly not.

Such a large residence could accommodate everyone even if Liang Wanwan got married and they all lived together.

With so many servants, they could all be taken care of.

It was simply because they didn't like her and wanted her to move out.

But this was understandable. The original owner would cause trouble outside from time to time. Father Liang had always been strict about disciplining children, so father and daughter would have conflicts.

Footnotes:

¹ "Sister-in-law" (妹妻) - Literally "younger sister's wife," referring to Xu Qingzhu as the wife of Liang Shi (who is the youngest daughter in the family).